

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Dental Assisting English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Dental assistants and dental support staff.

Fictional English practice, not dental training. Permitted duties, supervision, imaging authorization, and infection-prevention procedures depend on local requirements and qualifications. Refer diagnosis, treatment decisions, informed-consent questions, and aftercare advice to the authorized dental professional.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

- 01 Two bookings and an interpreter request
- 02 The spare tray is still awaiting a check
- 03 Which tray does the stock request mean?
- 04 The outside images have not arrived
- 05 A quieter discussion before deciding
- 06 The appointment date and the chart date differ
- 07 A crown case needs a revised estimate
- 08 A callback arrangement that can actually work

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Fictional English practice, not dental training. Permitted duties, supervision, imaging authorization, and infection-prevention procedures depend on local requirements and qualifications. Refer diagnosis, treatment decisions, informed-consent questions, and aftercare advice to the authorized dental professional.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Two bookings and an interpreter request

A patient calls a dental assistant after receiving two different appointment reminders.

Roles: Patient / Assistant

Patient: I have a consultation on Thursday, but this second reminder says Friday. Has Thursday been moved?

Assistant: Let me check both entries. Thursday is the consultation; Friday is a separate provisional slot awaiting confirmation.

Patient: I didn't realize Friday was provisional. I have to arrange time away from work for each visit.

Assistant: I understand. I can confirm Thursday at ten. Friday is not a confirmed treatment appointment yet.

Patient: Could you ask reception to explain when they'll be able to confirm or release that slot?

Assistant: Yes. I'll flag the time-off issue and ask them to contact you with the actual booking status.

Patient: I also requested an interpreter for Thursday. Does that request automatically cover Friday if I need it?

Assistant: No automatic arrangement is shown here. I'll ask reception to check interpreter availability for each confirmed visit.

Patient: Please make clear that I need the interpreter for the discussion, not only for the consent form.

Assistant: I'll record that request accurately. Which contact method already listed in your profile would you prefer?

Patient: The usual phone number, please. If I miss the call, use the agreed callback arrangement.

Assistant: Understood: confirm Friday separately, check the interpreter request, and call you through the existing contact arrangement.

Notice the professional language

'Provisional' means a booking is not yet final; it is not another word for rescheduled.

'For each confirmed visit' makes the scope explicit instead of extending one arrangement by assumption.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The spare tray is still awaiting a check

An assistant reports room readiness to the lead assistant during a busy morning.

Roles: Assistant / Lead assistant

Assistant: Room two's turnover is complete, but I can't confirm the sterilization record for the instrument tray delivered this morning.

Lead assistant: Thanks for separating those stages. Is the record missing entirely, or does the identifier fail to match?

Assistant: The record is present, but its identifier differs from the pack label. I haven't treated that pack as ready.

Lead assistant: Keep it out of the ready setup and follow our discrepancy process. I'll check the records now.

Assistant: Reception wants to know whether the patient can come through. What status can I give them?

Lead assistant: Tell them turnover is complete and the instrument check is pending. Don't give a completion time yet.

Assistant: The spare tray has arrived too. Does its arrival change that message, or is verification still outstanding?

Lead assistant: Verification is still outstanding. I need to confirm the spare's status before it becomes our replacement.

Assistant: I'll tell reception we have a possible replacement, not a confirmed ready tray. Who sends the next update?

Lead assistant: I will, once I've completed the required checks. Please keep the original mismatch linked to its pack reference.

Assistant: Understood. I'll pass on the current status and ask reception to acknowledge it before changing the room status.

Lead assistant: Thank you. I'll contact you and reception together so both teams receive the same readiness confirmation.

Notice the professional language

sterilization record - The required documentation used by the practice to verify an instrument-processing cycle.

instrument tray - The arranged set of instruments for a particular clinical task.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Which tray does the stock request mean?

An assistant clarifies a supply request with the lead assistant; no clinical procedure is being performed.

Roles: Assistant / Lead assistant

Assistant: The stock request just says 'two trays.' Do you mean instrument trays or impression trays for the cabinet?

Lead assistant: Instrument trays for storage, not impression trays. I left the description too short when I entered it.

Assistant: Thanks. There are also two sizes in the catalogue. The earlier order doesn't tell me which you intended.

Lead assistant: Use the size and product reference from the approved request attachment. I'm opening that attachment now.

Assistant: I can see the reference ending forty-two. Could you check the full reference against your copy before I submit?

Lead assistant: Yes, both copies show the same full reference. The quantity is two trays, not two boxes.

Assistant: That matters because the supplier's list has a separate box quantity. I'll keep the unit explicit.

Lead assistant: Please do. We only approved two individual trays, and I haven't authorized a larger quantity.

Assistant: The supplier shows them on backorder. Should I choose a similar item or ask about the delivery estimate?

Lead assistant: Ask for the estimate first. Any substitute needs review; a similar photograph isn't enough to approve it.

Assistant: I'll submit the clarification query, keep the purchase pending, and report the estimate when it arrives.

Lead assistant: Good. Include the exact reference and unit so the supplier can answer the question without guessing.

Notice the professional language

'Two trays, not two boxes' corrects the unit as well as the number.

'On backorder' indicates unavailable stock awaiting fulfillment, not a cancelled order.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The outside images have not arrived

An assistant checks an external-record request with the practice's records coordinator.

Roles: Assistant / Records coordinator

Assistant: The patient says their previous practice sent radiographs yesterday. I don't see them in the chart for today's consultation.

Records coordinator: I can check the transfer status. Do we have the verified patient record and the completed request?

Assistant: Yes, both are in our system. The request is recorded as sent, but I can't find a receipt confirmation.

Records coordinator: Then we know the request left us, not that the images arrived. I'll check the approved transfer channel.

Assistant: The patient thinks we must already have reviewed them. What can I accurately tell them while you check?

Records coordinator: Say the records team is confirming receipt. Don't imply that the dentist has seen or interpreted images we haven't located.

Assistant: Would their absence automatically mean another image will be taken here today, or is that a separate decision?

Records coordinator: That's a separate clinical decision for the dentist. A missing transfer does not establish a new imaging order.

Assistant: I'll pass on the patient's expectation and the current transfer status. Should I contact the previous practice again?

Records coordinator: Please let me handle that, so we avoid duplicate requests. I'll update the chart's transfer status after checking.

Assistant: Thanks. I'll tell the dentist receipt is unconfirmed and make no claim about the images' findings.

Records coordinator: Exactly. I'll report what actually arrives and whether any requested records are still outstanding.

Notice the professional language

imaging order - The authorized request specifying the imaging needed for a patient.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A quieter discussion before deciding

A patient tells an assistant what would help them understand the proposed treatment discussion.

Roles: Patient / Assistant

Patient: I couldn't follow everything the dentist said while the equipment was running in the next room. Could we go over it?

Assistant: Certainly. Which part would you like the dentist to explain again: the proposed treatment, the alternatives, or the timing?

Patient: The alternatives. I heard the word crown, but I don't understand why that option was mentioned for me.

Assistant: I can pass on that exact question. The dentist needs to explain the reason and the alternatives for your case.

Patient: Could my sister stay for that discussion? She helps me remember questions, but I want to answer for myself.

Assistant: I'll tell the dentist you want her support and time to give your own answers. We can check the arrangement together.

Patient: Thank you. I also need a slower explanation. Nodding earlier didn't mean I had understood all of it.

Assistant: I'll make that clear. Would it help if we list the questions aloud before the dentist returns?

Patient: Yes: why a crown was proposed, what the alternatives are, and what remains undecided after today's discussion.

Assistant: Those are the three questions I'll pass on. I won't describe a proposed option as a decision you've made.

Patient: That would help me feel less rushed. I don't need a promise; I need a clear explanation.

Assistant: I understand. I'll ask for the discussion to continue with those questions before anyone records a decision.

Notice the professional language

'Proposed' identifies an option under discussion, not an accepted treatment plan.

'Nodding didn't mean ...' respectfully corrects an inference about understanding.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The appointment date and the chart date differ

An assistant checks a documentation discrepancy with the records lead before a handoff.

Roles: Assistant / Records lead

Assistant: The referral summary lists the consultation as May fourteenth, but our appointment record shows May seventeenth. Which date is verified?

Records lead: Before choosing either one, check whether they're describing the same event. One could be the referral date.

Assistant: That's possible. The summary column only says 'date,' so I can't tell what event the entry refers to.

Records lead: Then request clarification from its source. Don't change our clinical chart just to make the two documents look consistent.

Assistant: I'll ask whether May fourteenth is the referral date or the consultation date. The dentist needs the distinction for today's review.

Records lead: Good. Mark the query as pending and keep the verified appointment entry separate from the unclear summary.

Assistant: If the source confirms an error, should I replace the earlier text or use the amendment process?

Records lead: Use our amendment process. The correction needs a clear connection to the original entry and the verified information.

Assistant: I also sent the summary in yesterday's handoff. Updating the chart alone won't tell the dentist about this query.

Records lead: Exactly. Notify the dentist through the approved channel that the date's meaning is still being checked.

Assistant: I'll say the records differ, not that the patient gave us a wrong date.

Records lead: That's accurate. Report the evidence and the unresolved question without assigning responsibility before we know what happened.

Notice the professional language

clinical chart - The authorized record of a patient's dental information and care.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A crown case needs a revised estimate

An assistant calls a laboratory coordinator after the dentist submits a query on a returned crown case.

Roles: Assistant / Lab coordinator

Assistant: Dr. Lee sent a query on crown case eighty-six this morning. Have you received the case reference and the clinician's comments?

Lab coordinator: Yes, the query arrived. Our review is pending; we haven't confirmed whether further work is needed yet.

Assistant: Reception is asking for a new appointment date. Can you give a revised turnaround estimate at this stage?

Lab coordinator: Not reliably until the review is complete. I can commit to a status update tomorrow at eleven.

Assistant: I'll distinguish that update from a delivery date. Does the query require any further information from the dentist?

Lab coordinator: The shade specification needs clarification. I'll send the exact question through the practice's approved channel, linked to this case.

Assistant: Please do. I can coordinate the response, but I won't choose a shade or alter the laboratory prescription myself.

Lab coordinator: Understood. Once the clinician clarifies it, we'll confirm how that affects the review and any proposed schedule.

Assistant: Should the returned case remain described as 'under review,' rather than 'remake agreed,' in our scheduling update?

Lab coordinator: Yes. A remake and any associated charge are not agreed simply because we've received a query.

Assistant: The lead assistant will be your contact. I'll tell reception that the next commitment is tomorrow's update, not completed work.

Lab coordinator: Thank you. I'll address that update to the lead assistant and identify anything still awaiting the dentist's response.

Notice the professional language

laboratory prescription - The authorized clinician's instructions to a dental laboratory for a specific case.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A callback arrangement that can actually work

A patient discusses a missed callback with an assistant; clinical questions remain with the dentist.

Roles: Patient / Assistant

Patient: I missed the dentist's call because I was on a train. Can someone call again about my postoperative instructions?

Assistant: I can pass on the callback request. Is it the same question about the phrase you identified earlier?

Patient: Yes, the same wording question. I haven't received an explanation yet, and I don't want it marked as answered.

Assistant: I'll record that the call was missed and the question remains unresolved, not that advice was received.

Patient: The number in my profile is correct, but I won't be free until after three. Can you promise a call then?

Assistant: I can record your availability, but I need the clinician to confirm a callback window before promising a time.

Patient: Please don't call my work reception instead. I only want the usual private contact arrangement used.

Assistant: I'll preserve that preference and flag it with your availability. A new contact method won't be assumed.

Patient: Does requesting another callback cancel the review appointment already booked for next week, or does that remain separate?

Assistant: It remains separate unless the appropriate team confirms a change. I'll ask reception to verify the existing booking too.

Patient: Thank you. Please tell me when a time is actually agreed, rather than saying the call is already booked.

Assistant: I will. If you report a new urgent concern, we'll follow our designated urgent route rather than this routine callback request.

Notice the professional language

postoperative instructions - The authorized guidance given after a dental procedure, which staff must not improvise or change.

review appointment - A planned follow-up visit for the clinician to assess or discuss care.

urgent concern - A time-sensitive issue that must follow the practice's designated urgent or emergency route.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Clarifying the appointment purpose

SHARED CASE

A fictional patient arrives expecting a filling today. The schedule shows a thirty-minute consultation, and no procedure is confirmed. The dentist can clarify the purpose before the patient decides whether to continue.

Role A | Responding professional

Check the appointment mismatch and explain what is confirmed. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you took time off expecting a filling and remember discussing it by phone. You do not have a written procedure confirmation.

Useful expressions

The schedule shows ____; you were expecting ____.

I haven't confirmed ____ for today's visit.

Let me check ____ before we say ____.

Cover this until after your first attempt

I see a thirty-minute consultation on today's schedule, but you were expecting a filling. I have not confirmed a procedure for this visit. Let me check with the dentist and reception before we describe what will happen today. Please tell us what you understood from the earlier booking conversation.

Second round

Reception finds a note saying 'discuss filling options.' Explain why that note does not by itself confirm that a filling will be performed.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Room readiness and safe clarification

SHARED CASE

A fictional instrument pack is present, but its required readiness documentation cannot be confirmed. The dentist is about to start. You are not authorized to waive the practice's checks. A verified replacement may be available through the lead assistant.

Role A | Responding professional

Name the unresolved check and ask for an authorized pause or alternative. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Dentist: you are ready to begin and need a concise statement of the unresolved issue and a workable authorized next step.

Useful expressions

Before we begin, I cannot confirm ____.

Could we hold ____ while ____ is checked?

The status is unverified, not confirmed as ____.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Before we start, I need to flag a readiness discrepancy. I cannot confirm the required record for this pack, so I am not treating it as ready for use. Could we hold this setup while the lead assistant follows the approved verification process or provides a verified replacement? I will report the status as soon as it is confirmed.

Second round

A colleague says the pack looks identical to a verified one. Explain why visual similarity does not answer the missing-record question.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Chairside requests and read-backs

SHARED CASE

During a fictional setup briefing, you hear 'tray' but miss the rest because another conversation interrupts. The list includes both an instrument tray and an impression tray. You have not selected either. Ask which tray is intended and read back the request before continuing under the practice's procedures.

Role A | Responding professional

Identify the exact missing word or detail instead of silently guessing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Dentist: you intended the impression tray, not the instrument tray. Confirm that full name when asked; do not introduce clinical use instructions.

Useful expressions

I heard ___, but not ___. Could you repeat that part?

Do you mean ___ for this setup?

Let me read that back: ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

I heard 'tray,' but I missed which kind because of the other conversation. The list includes both an instrument tray and an impression tray. Which one did you mean? I'll repeat the full name to check that I have understood before continuing with the setup.

Second round

The dentist uses 'that one' while looking away. Ask for an explicit description rather than relying on a direction you cannot see.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Imaging questions and authorization

SHARED CASE

A fictional patient asks whether an image proves that a tooth needs treatment. You are assisting with the visit and are not authorized to interpret the image. The dentist has not yet discussed it with the patient.

Role A | Responding professional

Respond to an imaging question by identifying the right decision-maker and preserving the patient's question. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you want to understand the image and do not want staff to make assumptions about your agreement to treatment.

Useful expressions

The clinician needs to interpret ___ before explaining ___.

I can help communicate your question, but I cannot decide ___.

Could you confirm the current order and authorization for ___?

Cover this until after your first attempt

The dentist needs to interpret the image and explain what it means for your care. I am not authorized to tell you whether it proves treatment is needed. I can let the dentist know you want that question answered before any decision is made, and help make sure you have an opportunity to ask it.

Second round

The patient says another assistant once explained a similar image. Keep the boundary about your own role without criticizing that person.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Patient comfort, questions, and pauses

SHARED CASE

A fictional patient is anxious and asks you to promise a procedure will not hurt. The dentist has not yet discussed comfort measures or the patient's concerns. You can help communicate the concern and ask the clinician to explain the plan and an appropriate pause signal.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge the concern and obtain a clinician-led explanation before a decision. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you had an uncomfortable experience elsewhere and want an honest explanation before deciding. You have not agreed to the proposed procedure.

Useful expressions

I hear that you're worried about ____.

I can't promise ____, but I can help you ask ____.

Before we begin, let's clarify ____ with the clinician.

Cover this until after your first attempt

I understand you are worried about discomfort. I cannot promise exactly how a procedure will feel for you. Before anything begins, let's ask the dentist to explain the comfort plan and how you can signal if you need attention or a pause. I will make sure your concern is passed on clearly.

Second round

The patient asks whether asking for a pause will annoy the team. Support the question and ask the clinician to establish the communication plan.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Records, identifiers, and factual handoffs

SHARED CASE

Two fictional patients share a surname. The appointment list and a folder label contain a mismatch in another identifier. You have not used the folder. The lead assistant can check the records through the approved process.

Role A | Responding professional

Identify conflicting sources and obtain an authorized record check. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Lead assistant: ask which records conflict and whether the folder has been used; initiate the approved check.

Useful expressions

The ___ shows ___, while the ___ shows ___.

I have not treated either version as confirmed.

Could the authorized person verify ___ before we proceed?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Before this folder is used, I need to flag an identifier mismatch between the appointment list and its label. Two patients share the surname, so that name alone does not resolve it. I have held the folder and need the approved identity check. Please confirm the correct record before the team proceeds.

Second round

A colleague recognizes the patient from a previous visit. Explain why recognition does not remove the record mismatch.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Laboratory cases and delivery expectations

SHARED CASE

A fictional laboratory estimates a case will arrive Tuesday by noon; the patient's appointment is at 14:00. Delivery is not guaranteed, and the dentist must confirm readiness before the appointment proceeds. The lab can provide a status update Monday at 16:00.

Role A | Responding professional

Link a delivery risk to a concrete update time and authorized scheduling decision. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Laboratory coordinator: noon Tuesday is an estimate, and you can commit to an update Monday at 16:00, not to guaranteed delivery.

Useful expressions

The current estimate is ____; the appointment is ____.

Could you confirm ____ by ____ so the team can decide ____?

Receipt does not yet confirm ____.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The appointment is Tuesday at two, and your current delivery estimate is noon that day. That leaves little time for the dentist's readiness check, so I cannot treat the appointment as secured by this estimate alone. Could you update us Monday at four? We will then ask the authorized team to confirm the scheduling decision.

Second round

Reception asks whether dispatch means the case is ready for the patient. Explain the remaining delivery and clinical checks.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Aftercare questions and follow-up calls

SHARED CASE

A fictional patient calls with an unclear phrase in their written postoperative instructions. You are not authorized to reinterpret or change those instructions. The clinician can answer through the practice's callback process. If the caller reports an urgent or emergency concern, use the designated route rather than an ordinary queue.

Role A | Responding professional

Identify the unclear instruction and obtain an appropriate authorized response. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: one phrase in your written instructions is unclear. You want a clinician's explanation and have not asked the assistant to diagnose anything.

Useful expressions

Which phrase in the instructions needs clarification?

I can relay ___, but the clinician needs to advise on ___.

The agreed callback window is ___; for an urgent concern, use ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Please tell me which phrase in the written instructions you want clarified. I can pass your question to the authorized clinician, but I should not reinterpret or change the guidance myself. We will use the appropriate contact process for your concern, and any urgent issue must follow the practice's designated urgent or emergency route.

Second round

The patient asks whether a missed callback means the question is unimportant. Explain that a communication delay does not establish clinical importance and use the appropriate follow-up route.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

I thought the treatment was today

At check-in, a patient and assistant discover different expectations.

01 • Patient: I took the morning off for my filling. Will the whole treatment fit into this appointment?

02 • Assistant: Today's schedule shows a thirty-minute consultation. I haven't confirmed a procedure for this visit.

03 • Patient: That's not what I understood when I called to make the booking last week.

04 • Assistant: I understand the difference matters. What were you told about the purpose of today's appointment?

05 • Patient: We discussed filling options, and I assumed that meant the filling would happen today.

06 • Assistant: Discussing options and booking treatment can be different steps. Let me clarify with the dentist.

07 • Patient: Please don't start anything until someone explains exactly what is planned and what isn't.

08 • Assistant: I'll pass that request on before the consultation begins and ask reception to check the booking note.

09 • Patient: Thank you. I would rather know the limits now than discover them halfway through the visit.

10 • Assistant: Agreed. I'll confirm the information we receive, without promising a procedure that hasn't been authorized.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Adding a concern to an existing slot

An assistant and receptionist coordinate a new question during a scheduled visit.

01 • Assistant: The patient booked a routine discussion but now wants the dentist to examine a separate concern.

02 • Receptionist: Can I simply add that to the same appointment slot and keep the original finish time?

03 • Assistant: I can't promise that. The dentist needs to decide what can appropriately be addressed during this visit.

04 • Receptionist: The patient is worried we will send them away without even hearing the new concern.

05 • Assistant: Please say we will pass it to the dental team, not that a particular procedure is guaranteed.

06 • Receptionist: Should I change the appointment type before the dentist has reviewed what the patient is asking?

07 • Assistant: Let's keep the confirmed booking separate from the request and ask for an authorized scheduling decision.

08 • Receptionist: I'll note that an additional concern was raised and that the appointment scope is awaiting clarification.

09 • Assistant: Good. The patient should hear the same explanation from both of us rather than two different promises.

10 • Receptionist: I'll confirm the outcome with you before I give the patient a revised finish-time estimate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Which visit does the reminder refer to?

An assistant helps a patient distinguish two upcoming appointments.

01 • Patient: I received two reminders, and both say dental visit. Are they duplicates for the same appointment?

02 • Assistant: Let's check the dates and appointment types before treating either reminder as a duplicate.

03 • Patient: One is Tuesday at ten, and the other is the following Monday at three.

04 • Assistant: The Tuesday booking shows a consultation. I'll ask reception to confirm the purpose of Monday's booking.

05 • Patient: So I shouldn't cancel Monday just because both messages use the same general wording?

06 • Assistant: Correct. Similar reminder text doesn't establish that the appointments have the same purpose or requirements.

07 • Patient: Can you explain that to reception? I don't want an accidental cancellation to cause another delay.

08 • Assistant: I'll explain that you are asking for clarification, not requesting cancellation of either appointment.

09 • Patient: Please ask them to use the actual dates when they explain the difference to me.

10 • Assistant: I will. We'll confirm each visit separately so you know what is booked and what remains unclear.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying the appointment purpose

A fictional patient arrives expecting a filling today. The schedule shows a thirty-minute consultation, and no procedure is confirmed. The dentist can clarify the purpose before the patient decides whether to continue.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you took time off expecting a filling and remember discussing it by phone. You do not have a written procedure confirmation.

Second round: Reception finds a note saying 'discuss filling options.' Explain why that note does not by itself confirm that a filling will be performed.

Scenario 2 | A transport booking depends on the finish time

The patient needs to book a ride home. The schedule reserves thirty minutes for a consultation, but the dentist has not confirmed the likely finish time. Reception can give updates after clarification.

Role A: Assistant: distinguish the reserved slot from a guaranteed departure time.

Role B: Patient: you must tell the transport company when to collect you and can request a flexible pickup.

Possible opening: Can I promise the driver I'll be outside exactly thirty minutes after the appointment starts?

Success checks

- Explain what the appointment slot does and does not establish.
- Avoid guaranteeing a finish time outside your authority.
- Identify who can clarify timing and how the patient will receive an update.

Add a complication: The patient asks you to guarantee that no additional discussion will be needed.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The record is not confirmed

An assistant raises a readiness concern before the fictional appointment begins.

01 • Assistant: Before we begin, I need to flag a discrepancy with the required readiness record for this pack.

02 • Dentist: Is something visibly wrong with the pack, or is the concern about its documented status?

03 • Assistant: The concern is that I cannot confirm the required record. I'm not making a conclusion from its appearance.

04 • Dentist: What do you need us to do while that information is checked through the approved process?

05 • Assistant: Please hold this setup. The lead assistant can verify the status or identify a verified replacement.

06 • Dentist: All right. Let the lead assistant know the appointment is waiting, but don't bypass the required check.

07 • Assistant: I will. I'll explain the urgency without presenting it as permission to treat an unknown status as acceptable.

08 • Dentist: What should we tell the patient while the team resolves the readiness question?

09 • Assistant: We can say we are completing a required preparation check and will update them when the room is ready.

10 • Dentist: Good. Give a factual update without guessing how long the check will take or overstating the finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Ready for which appointment?

Two assistants clarify a room-status message before the next patient is brought in.

01 • Assistant: Your message says room two is ready. Does that include the setup for the next booked appointment?

02 • Lead assistant: It means the approved room turnover is complete. I haven't confirmed the procedure-specific setup yet.

03 • Assistant: Then I shouldn't describe the whole operatory as fully ready for that patient at this point.

04 • Lead assistant: Correct. We need to distinguish completed turnover from the remaining setup check for the scheduled care.

05 • Assistant: The dentist asked for a status update. I'll name the completed stage and the item still being checked.

06 • Lead assistant: Please do. A short message can still be precise if it identifies which kind of readiness it means.

07 • Assistant: Would you like me to confirm with you again before I tell reception to bring the patient through?

08 • Lead assistant: Yes. Use the practice's usual readiness process rather than assuming the earlier message covers the later check.

09 • Assistant: I'll report that turnover is complete and the final appointment setup remains pending confirmation.

10 • Lead assistant: Thank you. I'll give you a clear update when the authorized check is complete and the status changes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A name on the tray list

An assistant clarifies a tray request rather than guessing between similar labels.

01 • Assistant: I heard you request the tray marked C, but there are two similar labels on today's list.

02 • Dentist: Thank you for checking. Which labels do you see, and what information is missing from my request?

03 • Assistant: One refers to the consultation setup and the other to a different procedure. I need the full description.

04 • Dentist: For this appointment, use the approved consultation setup after the usual readiness checks are complete.

05 • Assistant: Consultation setup for this appointment, subject to the normal checks. I won't substitute the other tray.

06 • Dentist: Exactly. If the labels remain confusing, ask the lead assistant to address the naming problem through our process.

07 • Assistant: I'll raise that separately so another worker doesn't have to infer the intended tray from an abbreviated request.

08 • Dentist: Good. Please keep the correction focused on the ambiguity, not on blaming whoever prepared the list.

09 • Assistant: I can say the labels are easily confused and suggest that the approved descriptions be made more distinct.

10 • Dentist: That would be useful. For now, your read-back has clarified the specific setup I meant for this visit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Room readiness and safe clarification

A fictional instrument pack is present, but its required readiness documentation cannot be confirmed. The dentist is about to start. You are not authorized to waive the practice's checks. A verified replacement may be available through the lead assistant.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Dentist: you are ready to begin and need a concise statement of the unresolved issue and a workable authorized next step.

Second round: A colleague says the pack looks identical to a verified one. Explain why visual similarity does not answer the missing-record question.

Scenario 2 | A rushed room-status message

Reception asks whether room three is ready. Turnover is complete, but the appointment-specific setup check is still pending. The lead assistant expects an update in five minutes but has not approved room use.

Role A: Assistant: distinguish completed turnover from pending setup and request that reception wait for confirmation.

Role B: Receptionist: you want to reduce the patient's wait and thought 'cleaned' meant fully ready.

Possible opening: The room has been cleaned, so can I bring the patient in now?

Success checks

- Name the completed stage and the pending stage.
- Request a specific pause without claiming contamination or danger not established by the facts.
- Confirm who will communicate the final readiness status.

Add a complication: The next patient has arrived early. Their arrival does not change the required readiness process.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The last word was lost

A noisy setup discussion makes an item name unclear.

01 • Assistant: I heard 'tray,' but not which kind. Could you repeat the full name for me?

02 • Dentist: The impression tray, please. I was looking at the second entry on our setup list.

03 • Assistant: The impression tray, not the instrument tray. Is that the one you meant for this appointment?

04 • Dentist: Yes, that's right. Both entries contain 'tray,' so my shortened request wasn't very helpful.

05 • Assistant: Thanks. I hadn't selected either because the conversation behind me covered the first word.

06 • Dentist: Please keep asking when you miss part of a request. I can repeat it.

07 • Assistant: Could we use the full names when both kinds appear on the same list?

08 • Dentist: Certainly. That should make the briefing clearer, especially while the next room is busy.

09 • Assistant: I'll mark the request as clarified. The usual preparation checks still need to be completed.

10 • Dentist: Agreed. Confirming the name doesn't mean the room is ready; please report that separately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The fault belongs to operator two

An assistant and lead assistant clarify a suction-equipment report before a room is described as ready.

01 • Assistant: The chairside note names a suction issue in operator two, but the service ticket lists room three. Which location is correct?

02 • Lead assistant: Operator two is correct. Room three was copied from an earlier ticket; that location needs correcting.

03 • Assistant: Thank you. I haven't tested the equipment or identified a cause, so I'll keep this as a reported issue.

04 • Lead assistant: That's right. The equipment lead will assess it. Please give them the room number and the original report.

05 • Assistant: Should I update reception as well? Their room board currently shows operator two as ready.

06 • Lead assistant: Yes. Tell reception its readiness is under review, and ask them to acknowledge the changed status.

07 • Assistant: I'll say operator two, suction issue reported, assessment pending. I won't give an unsupported repair time.

08 • Lead assistant: Good. Keep room three separate; this report doesn't establish any fault or change of status there.

09 • Assistant: Understood. I'll correct the ticket through the usual process and read the location back to the equipment lead.

10 • Lead assistant: Then let me know they've received it, so I can coordinate the next room update with reception.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A request made too quickly

A trainee assistant requests a clearer pace during a room briefing.

01 • Assistant: Could you separate the two setup requests? I caught the first, but the second came too quickly.

02 • Lead assistant: Of course. Tell me which request you understood so I don't simply repeat both just as fast.

03 • Assistant: You asked me to check the approved list for room one. I missed what should happen afterward.

04 • Lead assistant: After that check, report any discrepancy to me before the team describes the room as ready.

05 • Assistant: So I check the list, report any mismatch, and wait for the authorized readiness confirmation.

06 • Lead assistant: Exactly. The instruction is a sequence, not permission to skip the check when the schedule is busy.

07 • Assistant: Thank you. I'm comfortable with the words; I needed the order made explicit.

08 • Lead assistant: That's helpful feedback. I'll pause between the stages when we brief a new or complex setup.

09 • Assistant: I'll also say specifically which step I missed rather than just asking you to repeat everything.

10 • Lead assistant: Good. Clear questions and clear read-backs make the whole team less dependent on assumptions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Chairside requests and read-backs

During a fictional setup briefing, you hear 'tray' but miss the rest because another conversation interrupts. The list includes both an instrument tray and an impression tray. You have not selected either. Ask which tray is intended and read back the request before continuing under the practice's procedures.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Dentist: you intended the impression tray, not the instrument tray. Confirm that full name when asked; do not introduce clinical use instructions.

Second round: The dentist uses 'that one' while looking away. Ask for an explicit description rather than relying on a direction you cannot see.

Scenario 2 | An unfamiliar room abbreviation

At this fictional practice, a message says 'check OP4.' You do not know the local abbreviation. The lead assistant means checking the setup list for operator four, not declaring the room ready. No readiness check has been completed.

Role A: Assistant: ask what OP4 means and clarify which check is requested.

Role B: Lead assistant: in this practice OP means operator. You need the setup list checked for operator four; report any missing information to you.

Possible opening: Could you check OP4 before our room briefing?

Success checks

- Ask for the abbreviation to be expanded without guessing.
- Read back the room number and the requested check.
- Distinguish checking a list from confirming overall room readiness.

Add a complication: A second message mentions OP2. It concerns a separate appointment; clarify which room belongs to the current request.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Does the image prove it?

A patient asks an assistant for a clinical interpretation.

01 • Patient: Does that image prove I need treatment, or is the dentist still deciding what it means?

02 • Assistant: The dentist needs to interpret it and explain its meaning for your care. I can't make that determination.

03 • Patient: I can see a darker area, and I thought you might be able to tell me what it is.

04 • Assistant: I understand the question, but appearance alone isn't something I should interpret for you outside my authorized role.

05 • Patient: Can you make sure the dentist knows I want an explanation before I agree to anything?

06 • Assistant: Yes. I'll pass on that exact request rather than treating your question as agreement to a procedure.

07 • Patient: Thank you. I don't want to feel that the decision has already been made without a discussion.

08 • Assistant: I'll help make space for that discussion and identify the question you want answered first.

09 • Patient: Please also tell the dentist that I want the explanation in everyday words, not just technical names.

10 • Assistant: I will. You can ask about any term that remains unclear when the clinician explains the findings.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A possible retake is not an order

An assistant clarifies a passing comment about imaging.

01 • Assistant: I heard a comment that another image might be needed. Has an authorized imaging request actually been made?

02 • Dentist: Not yet. I was considering the information available and still need to decide the appropriate next step.

03 • Assistant: Then I will not treat that comment as an instruction to proceed with a retake.

04 • Dentist: Correct. Please keep the current status clear and follow the practice's authorization process for any imaging task.

05 • Assistant: The patient asked whether another image is definitely planned. What should I say at this stage?

06 • Dentist: Say that the clinician is reviewing the information and has not yet confirmed another image.

07 • Assistant: I'll distinguish consideration from a confirmed request, without giving a technical justification you haven't provided.

08 • Dentist: Thank you. If the order changes, we will communicate the authorized details through the usual process.

09 • Assistant: I'll also check that the task is within my permitted duties before taking any action.

10 • Dentist: Good. A clear order and the worker's authority are separate checks, and both matter.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Explaining a word, not a finding

A patient asks about terminology on an appointment note.

01 • Patient: The note says radiograph. Is that a different kind of appointment from the X-ray we discussed?

02 • Assistant: Radiograph means an X-ray image. I can explain that word, but I need to check the actual booking.

03 • Patient: So knowing the word doesn't tell us whether an image is definitely scheduled for this visit?

04 • Assistant: That's right. The appointment details and any current imaging order need separate confirmation through the practice.

05 • Patient: Could you check those before I assume this reminder means the plan has changed?

06 • Assistant: Yes. I'll ask the authorized team to clarify the visit and pass on your question accurately.

07 • Patient: I also have a question about why an image might be needed in my case.

08 • Assistant: That explanation should come from the dentist or other appropriately authorized clinician who knows the request.

09 • Patient: Please ask them to explain the reason rather than just tell me that it is routine.

10 • Assistant: I will. I'll distinguish your question about the word from your clinical question about the reason.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Imaging questions and authorization

A fictional patient asks whether an image proves that a tooth needs treatment. You are assisting with the visit and are not authorized to interpret the image. The dentist has not yet discussed it with the patient.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you want to understand the image and do not want staff to make assumptions about your agreement to treatment.

Second round: The patient says another assistant once explained a similar image. Keep the boundary about your own role without criticizing that person.

Scenario 2 | A copied order description

A colleague suggests copying an imaging description from a previous visit into today's setup message. Today's authorized order has not yet been verified. You do not know whether the earlier description still applies.

Role A: Assistant: explain why a previous entry cannot substitute for a current authorized request.

Role B: Colleague: you want to save time, but can ask the dentist to confirm today's order.

Possible opening: Can we use the same imaging description as last time to get the room moving?

Success checks

- Distinguish historical information from a current order.
- Ask the authorized person for the current request.
- Avoid advising on whether imaging is clinically necessary.

Add a complication: The patient remembers the earlier image too, but that memory does not establish today's request.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A promise the assistant cannot make

An anxious patient asks about comfort before the clinician explains the proposed care.

01 • Patient: Please promise me it won't hurt. I had a bad experience at another practice last year.

02 • Assistant: I'm sorry that experience has made this visit worrying. I can't promise exactly how this procedure would feel.

03 • Patient: That's an honest answer, but I still need to know how I can get someone's attention.

04 • Assistant: Let's ask the dentist to explain the comfort plan and agree on a pause signal you can use.

05 • Patient: Will the team be annoyed if I need to ask for that more than once?

06 • Assistant: Your concern deserves to be discussed. I'll tell the dentist that a clear communication plan would help you.

07 • Patient: I also want the explanation before anyone assumes that I'm ready to begin the procedure.

08 • Assistant: I'll make that request clear. Asking a question should not be treated as agreement to start.

09 • Patient: Thank you. I would rather understand the plan than hear a quick promise that might not be true.

10 • Assistant: I'll bring the dentist into the discussion so your specific questions can be answered by the right person.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A question behind the silence

An assistant checks whether a quiet patient has an unresolved concern.

01 • Assistant: Before I pass the information to the dentist, is there a question you still want them to address?

02 • Patient: I'm not sure how to ask it. Everyone seems busy, and I don't want to slow the appointment.

03 • Assistant: We can make time to identify the question. What part of the explanation is still unclear to you?

04 • Patient: I saw a crown on the treatment plan, but I don't understand why it's proposed instead of another option.

05 • Assistant: That's a question for the dentist to explain. May I tell them you want a comparison of the options?

06 • Patient: Yes, please. My silence didn't mean that I had understood the difference or agreed to the plan.

07 • Assistant: I'll make that distinction. I won't describe you as ready to proceed when you are still asking for information.

08 • Patient: Thank you. Could they use everyday words and check that I understand the important points?

09 • Assistant: I'll pass on that preference along with the question about the alternatives and their reasons.

10 • Patient: That would help. I want to participate in the decision, not simply nod because the words are unfamiliar.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The companion answers for the patient

An assistant protects space for the patient's own question.

01 • Companion: She is nervous, but she'll agree once you get started. You can tell the dentist to go ahead.

02 • Assistant: I can't treat that statement as the patient's decision. We need to hear her own questions and preferences.

03 • Companion: I'm only trying to help because she finds it difficult to speak when she's anxious.

04 • Assistant: Your support may be useful if she wants it. Let's give her time and ask how she would like you involved.

05 • Companion: Would it help if I explain what she told me on the way to the appointment?

06 • Assistant: You can offer that information with her agreement, while the clinician checks the decision through the appropriate process.

07 • Companion: I don't want my confidence to make it seem that she has already agreed when she hasn't said so.

08 • Assistant: Exactly. We can support the conversation without replacing her own voice or the clinician's explanation.

09 • Companion: I'll ask whether she wants me to help explain the concern, then let her answer the dentist.

10 • Assistant: Thank you. I'll tell the dentist that she may need a slower discussion and time for questions before deciding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Patient comfort, questions, and pauses

A fictional patient is anxious and asks you to promise a procedure will not hurt. The dentist has not yet discussed comfort measures or the patient's concerns. You can help communicate the concern and ask the clinician to explain the plan and an appropriate pause signal.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you had an uncomfortable experience elsewhere and want an honest explanation before deciding. You have not agreed to the proposed procedure.

Second round: The patient asks whether asking for a pause will annoy the team. Support the question and ask the clinician to establish the communication plan.

Scenario 2 | A question after the explanation

The dentist has explained a proposed procedure, but the patient tells you they still do not understand one term. No decision is established by this scenario. You can ask the dentist to revisit the explanation.

Role A: Assistant: acknowledge the unresolved term and help the patient obtain clarification.

Role B: Patient: you nodded because you felt embarrassed, not because you understood.

Possible opening: I nodded earlier, but I don't actually know what that term means for me.

Success checks

- Distinguish hearing an explanation from understanding it.
- Avoid labeling the patient's earlier nod as a decision.
- Bring the specific question back to the authorized clinician.

Add a complication: A colleague says the explanation has already been given. You still need to communicate that understanding remains unresolved.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The surname matches, but the record does not

An assistant reports a discrepancy before a folder is used.

01 • Assistant: I need an identity check before this folder is used. The surname matches, but another patient identifier differs.

02 • Lead assistant: Which two sources are you comparing, and has the folder already been used during today's appointment?

03 • Assistant: I'm comparing the appointment list with the folder label. I have held the folder and haven't used it.

04 • Lead assistant: Two patients share that surname, so we need the approved verification process rather than a guess.

05 • Assistant: A colleague recognizes the patient from last month. I don't think that resolves the document mismatch itself.

06 • Lead assistant: It doesn't. Recognition may be additional context, but the conflicting records still need the authorized check.

07 • Assistant: I'll keep the details within the approved private channel and avoid discussing them across the waiting room.

08 • Lead assistant: Please describe the discrepancy precisely without deciding which version is wrong before it is verified.

09 • Assistant: Once the correct record is confirmed, who will handle any necessary amendment to the inaccurate entry?

10 • Lead assistant: The authorized records process will determine that. I'll confirm the outcome before the team proceeds with the folder.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Whose words are in the note?

A chart phrase may be an interpretation rather than a quotation.

01 • Lead assistant: The note says the patient refused to discuss the plan. Did they actually use those words during the visit?

02 • Assistant: No. They said they needed more time to understand one term. My wording interpreted that as refusal.

03 • Lead assistant: Those meanings differ. We need a factual amendment through the approved process so the next clinician understands the request.

04 • Assistant: I can identify the actual statement and explain that my earlier phrase was an interpretation, not a direct quotation.

05 • Lead assistant: Please also clarify whether a final decision was made, rather than letting the corrected note imply one.

06 • Assistant: No final decision was established. The patient asked for another explanation before deciding about the proposed care.

07 • Lead assistant: Then preserve that uncertainty. An unresolved question is not automatically agreement, refusal, or unwillingness to cooperate.

08 • Assistant: I'll use neutral wording and alert the authorized team so the earlier phrase doesn't keep circulating.

09 • Lead assistant: What will you say in the handoff to the dentist who is seeing the patient next?

10 • Assistant: The patient requested clarification before deciding, and the earlier refusal wording has been referred for amendment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A private record in a public space

An assistant redirects a records discussion away from a reception queue.

01 • Receptionist: Can you confirm details from this patient's chart while I have the next three people waiting here?

02 • Assistant: Let's use the approved private channel. We shouldn't discuss unnecessary patient details where other visitors can hear.

03 • Receptionist: I only need to know whether the record mismatch is resolved before I update the appointment status.

04 • Assistant: The authorized check is still pending. I can confirm that without repeating the private identifiers in the queue.

05 • Receptionist: Then I should leave the status pending rather than mark it verified just to keep the line moving.

06 • Assistant: Correct. The number of people waiting doesn't establish that the conflicting information has been checked.

07 • Receptionist: Who should I contact for a time estimate for the next update to the patient?

08 • Assistant: The lead assistant is handling the check. Please ask them through the usual communication route.

09 • Receptionist: I'll explain the administrative delay without sharing another person's details or suggesting that the patient caused it.

10 • Assistant: Thank you. A useful status update can still limit disclosure to information appropriate to the purpose.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Records, identifiers, and factual handoffs

Two fictional patients share a surname. The appointment list and a folder label contain a mismatch in another identifier. You have not used the folder. The lead assistant can check the records through the approved process.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead assistant: ask which records conflict and whether the folder has been used; initiate the approved check.

Second round: A colleague recognizes the patient from a previous visit. Explain why recognition does not remove the record mismatch.

Scenario 2 | A copied note with the wrong date

A draft handoff includes a previous visit's date. Today's date is verified, but you cannot silently overwrite finalized entries. The records lead handles corrections.

Role A: Assistant: flag the discrepancy and ask whether the entry is finalized.

Role B: Records lead: determine the entry's status and direct the approved correction process.

Possible opening: This handoff appears to include the previous visit's date; can we check its status before use?

Success checks

- Name the mismatch and its source.
- Do not hide or silently overwrite a finalized record.
- Confirm the correction route and notify the appropriate recipient.

Add a complication: A colleague asks you to erase the old entry so nobody sees the mistake.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Noon is an estimate

An assistant and laboratory coordinator discuss a tight delivery window.

01 • Assistant: The patient is booked Tuesday at two. Your current delivery estimate is noon, leaving a tight window.

02 • Lab coordinator: That's our estimate, but it isn't guaranteed. The case also needs the practice's checks after it arrives.

03 • Assistant: Then I can't tell reception that the appointment is secured simply because delivery is expected before two.

04 • Lab coordinator: Correct. We can update the case status Monday at four so your team has better information.

05 • Assistant: Could that update distinguish production completion, dispatch, and expected delivery rather than just saying it is on track?

06 • Lab coordinator: Yes. I'll report the actual stage and flag anything that changes the current delivery expectation.

07 • Assistant: The dentist will need to make the readiness decision, and reception will confirm any scheduling changes.

08 • Lab coordinator: Understood. We won't describe our dispatch confirmation as a clinical sign-off for the patient's appointment.

09 • Assistant: I'll tell the team when to expect your update and keep the current arrival time labeled as an estimate.

10 • Lab coordinator: I'll contact you Monday at four even if the status is unresolved, so you aren't left waiting without information.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An unclear shade instruction

A laboratory query requires the clinician's clarification rather than an assistant's guess.

01 • Lab coordinator: The shade entry on the prescription is unclear. Can you tell us which of these two readings is intended?

02 • Assistant: I can see the ambiguity, but I am not authorized to choose the specification on the clinician's behalf.

03 • Lab coordinator: Could you ask the clinician to clarify it through the approved channel using this case reference?

04 • Assistant: Yes. I'll pass on both possible readings and make clear that the laboratory hasn't received a confirmed answer.

05 • Lab coordinator: Please don't send the more likely reading as though it were the authorized instruction for production.

06 • Assistant: I won't. I'll distinguish my transcription question from the clinician's actual specification and request a verified response.

07 • Lab coordinator: We can hold the affected stage while the query is resolved, but it may change the turnaround time.

08 • Assistant: Please state that timing risk in the update so the practice can review the appointment plan.

09 • Lab coordinator: I'll do that. Let us know when the authorized clarification has been received, not just requested.

10 • Assistant: Agreed. I'll confirm receipt and ask you to read back the clarified specification through the practice's approved process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Delivered is not clinically approved

An assistant explains the status of a returned laboratory case to reception.

01 • Receptionist: The parcel has arrived, so can I tell the patient everything is ready for the appointment?

02 • Assistant: Arrival is confirmed, but the dentist's required check has not yet been completed for this case.

03 • Receptionist: I thought delivery meant the laboratory had finished the work and there was nothing else to confirm.

04 • Assistant: It confirms a logistics stage. It doesn't replace the practice's identification and clinical readiness checks.

05 • Receptionist: Should I leave the appointment status unchanged until the authorized team gives me a clear update?

06 • Assistant: Please follow our usual process and wait for that confirmation before promising readiness to the patient.

07 • Receptionist: The patient is asking whether to leave home. Who should give the next timing update?

08 • Assistant: The lead assistant is coordinating the check with the dentist and can provide the verified status.

09 • Receptionist: I'll explain that the case has arrived and the final check is pending, without suggesting a problem was found.

10 • Assistant: That's accurate. Pending verification is not the same as a confirmed defect, and we should not imply either outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Laboratory cases and delivery expectations

A fictional laboratory estimates a case will arrive Tuesday by noon; the patient's appointment is at 14:00. Delivery is not guaranteed, and the dentist must confirm readiness before the appointment proceeds. The lab can provide a status update Monday at 16:00.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Laboratory coordinator: noon Tuesday is an estimate, and you can commit to an update Monday at 16:00, not to guaranteed delivery.

Second round: Reception asks whether dispatch means the case is ready for the patient. Explain the remaining delivery and clinical checks.

Scenario 2 | A second parcel with a similar reference

Two lab parcels arrive with similar case references. One patient is due at 14:00. The identifiers on one parcel need clarification, and the authorized team has not approved either case for use.

Role A: Assistant: ask the lab to verify the reference through the approved private channel.

Role B: Lab coordinator: you can check dispatch records but cannot make the dentist's clinical readiness decision.

Possible opening: Before we associate this parcel with today's appointment, can you confirm the full case reference?

Success checks

- Verify the specific case instead of assuming from timing.
- Protect private identifiers during the query.
- Keep receipt, identity verification, and clinical approval distinct.

Add a complication: Reception wants to rely on the expected arrival date because the patient is on the way.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The written phrase is unclear

A fictional aftercare sheet says 'resume your usual routine.' No interpretation is supplied. The patient has a wording question, and no urgent concern has been reported.

01 • Patient: The sheet says resume your usual routine. Does that mean returning to work, or does it include exercise too?

02 • Assistant: You want to know what usual routine includes, particularly work and exercise. Have I understood your question?

03 • Patient: Yes. I don't want you to change the instructions; I need the clinician to explain that phrase.

04 • Assistant: I'll pass on that exact wording and both examples. I haven't confirmed what the clinician intended it to cover.

05 • Patient: Could they call the number already in my record? I won't be able to answer between one and two.

06 • Assistant: I'll include that availability. Have you requested a call about this sheet already, or is this the first contact?

07 • Patient: This is the first call. I was wondering whether I'd need another appointment just to ask.

08 • Assistant: A callback request isn't an appointment booking. I'll check the response arrangements and confirm what the team agrees.

09 • Patient: Thank you. Please tell them I'm asking about the phrase on the sheet, not reporting a new symptom.

10 • Assistant: I'll keep that distinction in the message and ask who will respond. I don't have a confirmed callback time yet.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An overdue callback

An assistant follows up on an unanswered patient question.

01 • Assistant: The patient says the agreed callback window has passed without contact. I need to follow up through our approved process.

02 • Lead assistant: Has the patient reported a new concern, or are they asking about the unanswered question already sent to the clinician?

03 • Assistant: They are asking about the same unclear instruction. I haven't interpreted the delay as a judgment about its importance.

04 • Lead assistant: Good. A missed communication commitment doesn't tell us whether a clinical concern is significant or not.

05 • Assistant: Who owns the next contact? I don't want to promise another time without an authorized commitment from the team.

06 • Lead assistant: I'll check with the clinician and confirm the appropriate response route and next update through our usual process.

07 • Assistant: I'll tell the patient the callback is being followed up, not that their question has been clinically assessed as unimportant.

08 • Lead assistant: Exactly. If an urgent concern is reported, use the designated urgent pathway rather than leaving it in an ordinary queue.

09 • Assistant: I'll follow the screening procedure and report the caller's actual words without making my own clinical assessment.

10 • Lead assistant: Thank you. Once the next contact is confirmed, communicate it clearly and check that the patient understands the arrangement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Review visit or phone contact?

A patient checks two different follow-up arrangements.

01 • Patient: My reminder shows a review appointment next week, but someone also mentioned calling me tomorrow. Are those the same arrangement?

02 • Assistant: A callback and a review appointment are different. Let's verify which contacts have actually been booked or agreed.

03 • Patient: I don't want to cancel next week's visit just because I expect a phone conversation tomorrow.

04 • Assistant: That's sensible. The phone contact doesn't automatically replace the review appointment unless the authorized team confirms a change.

05 • Patient: Can you check the exact date and purpose of the review while you confirm the callback arrangement?

06 • Assistant: Yes. I'll ask reception and the clinical team to clarify each item through the approved process.

07 • Patient: Please also tell them I have a question for the clinician, rather than writing that I want to stop follow-up care.

08 • Assistant: I'll preserve that distinction. Asking about the arrangements isn't the same as asking to cancel or decline care.

09 • Patient: Thank you. I need one clear explanation of what happens tomorrow and what remains scheduled for next week.

10 • Assistant: I'll report the verified details separately and identify anything that is still awaiting confirmation before you make plans.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Aftercare questions and follow-up calls

A fictional patient calls with an unclear phrase in their written postoperative instructions. You are not authorized to reinterpret or change those instructions. The clinician can answer through the practice's callback process. If the caller reports an urgent or emergency concern, use the designated route rather than an ordinary queue.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: one phrase in your written instructions is unclear. You want a clinician's explanation and have not asked the assistant to diagnose anything.

Second round: The patient asks whether a missed callback means the question is unimportant. Explain that a communication delay does not establish clinical importance and use the appropriate follow-up route.

Scenario 2 | Advice remembered from a previous procedure

The patient asks whether instructions from an earlier procedure can replace the current written guidance. You have not verified any equivalence and are not authorized to change instructions. The appropriate clinician can clarify through the designated process.

Role A: Assistant: explain why prior guidance cannot simply be assumed to apply.

Role B: Patient: you remember the earlier wording more clearly and want to know which guidance is current.

Possible opening: Last time the instructions were different. Should I just follow the old ones again?

Success checks

- Distinguish previous instructions from current guidance.
- Do not choose, reinterpret, or invent clinical advice.
- Route the question using the appropriate regular or urgent process.

Add a complication: The patient asks you to choose the most convenient version before the clinician responds.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional English practice, not dental training. Permitted duties, supervision, imaging authorization, and infection-prevention procedures depend on local requirements and qualifications. Refer diagnosis, treatment decisions, informed-consent questions, and aftercare advice to the authorized dental professional.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS: Dental Assistants

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/healthcare/dental-assistants.htm>

CDC: Plain Language

<https://www.cdc.gov/health-literacy/php/develop-materials/plain-language.html>

NIDCR: Dental Materials

<https://www.nidcr.nih.gov/grants-funding/funded-research/research-investments-advances/dental-materials>

National Dental Practice-Based Research Network: Impression Techniques for Single-Unit Crowns

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5794617/>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Dental Assisting English

Professional audience: Dental assistants and dental support staff

Scope: Fictional English practice, not dental training. Permitted duties, supervision, imaging authorization, and infection-prevention procedures depend on local requirements and qualifications. Refer diagnosis, treatment decisions, informed-consent questions, and aftercare advice to the authorized dental professional.

Dialogue 01: Two bookings and an interpreter request

Original fictional setting: A patient calls a dental assistant after receiving two different appointment reminders.

Professional roles: Patient / Assistant

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Patient: I have a consultation on Thursday, but this second reminder says Friday. Has Thursday been moved?

Assistant: Let me check both entries. Thursday is the consultation; Friday is a separate provisional slot awaiting confirmation.

Patient: I didn't realize Friday was provisional. I have to arrange time away from work for each visit.

Assistant: I understand. I can confirm Thursday at ten. Friday is not a confirmed treatment appointment yet.

Patient: Could you ask reception to explain when they'll be able to confirm or release that slot?

Assistant: Yes. I'll flag the time-off issue and ask them to contact you with the actual booking status.

Patient: I also requested an interpreter for Thursday. Does that request automatically cover Friday if I need it?

Assistant: No automatic arrangement is shown here. I'll ask reception to check interpreter availability for each confirmed visit.

Patient: Please make clear that I need the interpreter for the discussion, not only for the consent form.

Assistant: I'll record that request accurately. Which contact method already listed in your profile would you prefer?

Patient: The usual phone number, please. If I miss the call, use the agreed callback arrangement.

Assistant: Understood: confirm Friday separately, check the interpreter request, and call you through the existing contact arrangement.

Vocabulary in this exchange: consultation: A visit for discussing or assessing a concern with the appropriate dental professional. / callback: A return contact arranged to respond to a patient's question or request.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
 2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
 3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
 4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
 5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.
- Use voice replies when available. If I prefer selections, offer four plausible spoken replies and explain my choice before continuing. Do not require written compositions.

END PROMPT

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

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Vocabulary in this exchange: consultation: A visit for discussing or assessing a concern with the appropriate dental professional. / callback: A return contact arranged to respond to a patient's question or request.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT